

## Delaware County Council Meeting January 23rd 2024

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lt06qxQlgyQ">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lt06qxQlgyQ</a> |
| Publication Date | 2024-01-24T04:08:42Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | delaware_county                                                                                       |

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## Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

**Meeting Date:** January 23, 2024

**Body:** Delaware County Council

### 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer M. Piper called the regular Delaware County Council meeting to order at [00:06:43](#).
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present:** Members Flangin, Hughes, K (Clemens/K), Mogul (Mel), Webb, Wad (Wyatt), and Presiding Officer Piper.
  - **Absent:** None noted.
  - **Presiding Officer:** M. Piper.

### 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:06:53](#), followed by a moment of silence [00:07:21](#) in remembrance of Becky Flowers, a county employee in the auditor's office who passed away recently.
- **Approval of Agenda:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).

- **Approval of Minutes:**

- December 12, 2023 County Council meeting minutes approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- January 3, 2024 Special meeting minutes approved by roll call vote (6-0, with Mr. Webb abstaining).

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## 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

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*(Note: The finance committee met prior and gave a favorable recommendation to all routine transfers and appropriations 00:09:19. Unless otherwise noted, budget transfers reflected zero-sum backfills/realignments.)*

- **00:09:32 Department 138 - Circuit Court:** Transfer of \$31,743 within Probation Support Staff.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:10:19 Department 124 - Communications:** Transfer of \$41,798.10 within Communication Tech.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:10:59 Department 145 - Jail:** Transfers totaling \$38,372.92 (Correctional Officer) and \$35,840 (Corporal) to balance shifts and establish supervisory positions.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:13:13 Introduction of New Chief Public Defender:** Sam Beasley was introduced to the council as the new Chief Public Defender, succeeding Kelly.
- **00:14:54 Department 139 - Public Defender:** Transfers reflecting staff adjustments, including legal secretary, public defender, and chief public defender salary realignments (total transfer zero).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:15:44 Department 129 - Sheriff:** Multiple line-item transfers and additions for lieutenants, corporals, deputies, captains, and bailiffs made following post-budget promotions.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:18:31 Department 123 - Title IV-D Court:** Transfer of \$32,132 for assistant court reporter backfill.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:19:06 Department 117-45 - LIT Jail:** Transfer of \$39,046 for correctional officer backfill.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:19:43 Department 117-6 - Motor Vehicle Highway:** Transfer of \$58,181.44 adjusting truck drivers and equipment operators due to longevity and role changes.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).

- **00:20:48 Department 129 Addendum - County General Sheriff:** Transfers for lieutenants and corporals (\$55,312.36 and \$50,585.04).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:21:35 Department 117-6 Addendum - Motor Vehicle Highway:** Transfer of \$40,800 for truck drivers.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:22:13 Department 145 Financial - County General Jail:** Additional \$750 allocation for a correctional officer line item inadvertently missed during budget calculations.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:23:45 Adult User Fee Fund 2100:** Allocation of \$4,711 to reclassify a part-time probation officer to a full-time probation officer assistant to assist juvenile caseloads.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:26:39 Comprehensive Plan Fund 1180:** Annual fund allocation totaling \$175,000 across Professional Services (\$155,000), travel, printing, dues, schooling, public meetings, and computer equipment.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:30:19 EMS Capital Improvements Fund 4910:** Appropriation totaling \$100,985 (as amended/re-read to remove a duplicated \$61,763 entry) for Motorola repeater/transmitter installation (\$6,033) and power load cot systems (\$94,947) to safeguard personnel and patients.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:36:45 Family Recovery Court Grant Fund 8192:** Additional grant allocation of \$3,446 for program coordinator salary and benefits due to a higher grant award.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:38:44 GIS Map Fund 1150:** Annual fund allocation totaling \$150,000 for computer support, professional services (aerial pictometry, beacon services), travel, schooling, dues, and equipment.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:41:07 Comprehensive Highway Injury Reduction Program (CHIRP) Fund 8109** (*formerly Juvenile DUI Grant*): Appropriation of \$91,418.4 for grant salaries (100% reimbursable).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:43:16 Opioid Grant Fund 8199:** Appropriation of \$31,250 for peer recovery coach salaries.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:43:51 Sales Disclosure Fund 1131:** Annual allocation of \$5,950 for assessment supplies, schooling, dues, and property record PDF postings.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
- **00:46:16 Sex and Violent Admin Fund 1192:** Appropriation of \$12,000 (\$6,000 supplies, \$6,000 phone/computers).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).

- **00:46:48 Unsafe Building Fund 1207:** Annual allocation of \$65,000 (\$500 supplies, \$500 recording fees, \$64,000 unsafe buildings/demolition) funded by 10% of incoming building permit fees.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
  - **01:23:48 Approval of 2024 Encumbrances:** Approval of prior-year invoice encumbrances to carry over funds into 2024 without reappropriation.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (7-0).
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## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

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- *No members of the public signed up or spoke during the public comment period.*
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## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

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- **Staff & Board Announcements:**
    - **Tax Abatement Committee Report (00:54:59):** Bill Hughes reported on the committee's review of solar energy project tax abatements (Meadow Forge and Hawthorne). The report highlighted maximum property tax levy caps, agricultural land designations under recent court rulings, and a controversial "Economic Development Agreement" (EDA) provision signed by the County Commissioners granting potential tax credits. The council discussed planning a special hearing following discussions with the County Commissioners and solar developers.
    - **Sheriff's Office Update (01:25:41):** Sheriff Tony Skinner announced that the jail crossed the \$2 million mark in revenue from housing out-of-county and federal inmates over the last three years. He also advocated for future salary increases for correctional officers.
    - **Coroner's Office Update (01:31:09):** Coroner Gavin Green presented the 2023 year-end report, noting 564 total cases (334 signed personally), including 152 accidents (overdoses), 10 homicides, 33 suicides, and 129 natural deaths. He detailed the heavy call burden and per-case pay structure for deputy coroners.
    - **Council Member Comments (01:42:31):** Council members discussed departmental documentation standards for professional services, expressed opposition to proposed state legislation restricting meeting decorum, and noted high attendance at the recent Indiana County Councils Association East Central district meeting.
  - **Adjournment:** Official adjournment to the next regular meeting on Tuesday, February 27, 2024, at 9:00 a.m., approved by roll call vote (7-0) **01:47:19**.
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